House of Rogues

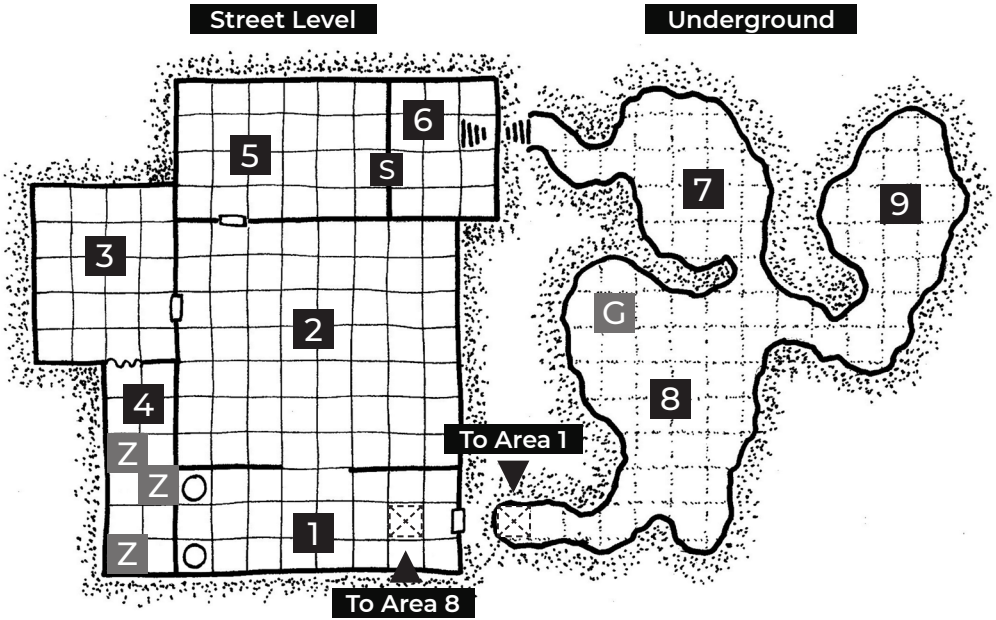
The home of the murderous sorcerer Belshazzar holds a terrible secret!

Belshazzar has put a **contract** out into the city's dark underworld: Kill you and your companions, payable on delivery. The city's worst thugs and assassins now chase your shadows. The only hope for survival is to cut the contract off at its source. Belshazzar must die!

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	Ambush by a Guild **assassin**
2	Mob of 2d6 overconfident **thugs** looking to collect on the contract
3	1d4 **zombies** from Area 4
4	2d6 City Guard (**soldiers**) who say neighbors heard cries for help

Hulbazizi. A green quartz stone carved with a protective incantation. Once per day, wielder can cast *protection from evil* without a spellcasting check (lasts 5 rounds). Each time, 1:100 chance of summoning a hostile **glabrezu**.



S Secret door: sliding wall panel

Shadowdark RPG
3rd-Level
K. Dionne, 2026

1. Grand Foyer. A lofty hallway paneled in dark wood. Oil lamps along the walls are burned out and cold. Two **statues** of visored knights hold brightly polished **mirrors** instead of shields that point at the front door. Near the entrance, a hidden **trapdoor** in the floor goes to Area 8 (it has a small **peephole** that slides open from the underside).

2. Sitting Room. A grand entertaining lounge strewn with plush rugs and deep couches. Sandalwood **incense** fails to mask the scent of wet fur. Macabre bits of **decor** hide in plain sight: a shrunken head oil lamp, a human leg bone as a fire poker, a hairy tarantula in a jar of green liquid. A ***Potion of Forgetfulness*** sits amid the bottles on a liquor cart.

3. Parlor. Green velvet upholstery, a thick rug, and a mahogany table scattered with ivory **dominoes** (40 gp) set up to play a simple child's game. One of the four **chairs** is massive; it has long gouges in the wooden armrests and spears of white fur in the cushions. A heavy velvet **curtain** covers the door to Area 4 (the smell of rotting meat emanates from underneath it).

4. Kitchen. Flies cluster on thick slabs of marbled **meat** left out on cutting blocks. A human spine hangs from a hook. 3 **zombies** lurk in metal tubs pushed beneath the counters; they claw their way out when they smell the living. One zombie has a gold hoop earring (30 gp).

5. Bedroom. Dark **blood** soaks into the mattress of a shredded four-post bed. Pillows, lamps, and books (one is the *Tome of Hadebe*) are thrown around. A drag mark of blood ends abruptly at the wall before the **secret door** to Area 6.

6. Hidden Classroom. A broad table and massive chair sit before a scarred **chalkboard**. It says "Punishments" in a clear hand with five tally marks below it. Under that, lines of shaky handwriting spell out a repeated phrase: "I will not bite. I will listen. I will learn."

7. Discipline Chamber. Two sets of enchanted iron **manacles** are bolted to the floor. Any creature touching a set must pass a DC 15 DEX check or be instantly clamped into it (DC 20 STR to break, DC 20 DEX to pick lock). A wall **rack** holds a selection of cruel whips.

8. Cellar. Wine casks and racks of stored food. An enormous **man** in a hooded, red cloak sits in the corner with his back turned (this is actually a white **gorilla** named Tomu who can speak and write in Common). He is chewing on Belshazzar's femur. He **mutters** repeatedly to himself in an imitation of the sorcerer's reedy voice: "He still has a taste for man-flesh. I am trying to wean him from it." The gorilla hates humans and wants vengeance for his captivity and abuse at Belshazzar's hands. The ***Hulbazizi*** is in his cloak pocket.

A ladder leads to a hidden **trapdoor** in the 8' ceiling to Area 1 (it has a small **peephole** that slides open to give a clear view of the mirrors in Area 1).

9. Ape Cave. A narrow cave with a bed that reeks of wet fur and rot. Heavy wall **manacles** have been torn free of their bolts. The bed's covers are pulled over the mangled **body** of Belshazzar (his left leg is missing). He wears a ruby ring with a gold snake band worth 200 gp. Proof of his death to the Thieves' Guild ends the kill **contract** against the PCs.